
Major Project

Artefact: Assessment Brief

Introduction

You are required to deliver a major project as part of your master's degree; in the form of research and/or innovation relating to your specialism, encompassing empirical and/or practice-based research. Individually, you will explore a field that interests you, and for which there is a clearly identified need.

The higher-level aim for this module is to support you on your journey through a research and innovation project that has the potential to contribute new knowledge in a chosen field of study, produce an artefact that is of publishable quality, and develop your personal portfolio in a way that supports your future aspirations. If your project is particularly strong, there may be scope for taking it forward for publication in academic conferences or seeking business start-up funding.

For this module, you are required to complete one assignment, composed of two parts: a **Proposal**, and an **Artefact**.

Note that this module is worth 60 credits, which is twice as many credits as your previous modules. As such the expectation is that the amount of work you put into this module is roughly double that of previous modules.

Project Scope

The brief for this project is intentionally open-ended. You will be assigned a supervisor, a member of the academic team whose role is to mentor you through the project. With your supervisor's aid, you will refine your proposal and then deliver your project.

Your project may be:

- A standalone individual project, where you undertake all of the work yourself.
- An individual contribution to a group project with other GAM708 students.
 - Note that each member of the group must have a well-defined contribution to the overall project.
- An individual contribution to an external project. Some students at this stage of their studies may be working as interns or part-time employees in the industry, as members of teams under incubation schemes such as Transfuzer, or collaborating with students from other courses. In this case, you may leverage this work as the basis for your major project as long as:
 - You are able to fulfil the requirements of this assignment.
 - You are making a well-defined contribution to the external project.
 - You obtain permission from your external partners, in particular addressing any issues around intellectual property or commercially sensitive information.

The main aim of this project is to produce an artefact. The definition of "artefact" is intentionally open-ended, but it should be a physical or digital work which satisfies a clearly identified need for an intended audience. The artefact types listed below each carry specific submission requirements in addition to the standard components; these are set out in the Artefact section of this brief.

- **Software product:** for example, a game, an app, or a reusable software component. This could be a marketable product, or a demo/prototype.
- **Written dissertation:** a long-form piece of academic writing, based on an in-depth review of relevant academic literature and possibly a piece of primary research, making a contribution to knowledge in a particular specialist field.
- **Portfolio of creative work:** for example, a portfolio of high-quality art assets, presented professionally and coherently, demonstrating your artistic process.
- **Anything else:** the brief is intentionally open-ended, and you are welcome to discuss with your supervisor what might constitute a suitable artefact.

Developing your concept

To help you conceive a topic for your project, try to:

1. Review the state-of-the-art from your industry and/or academic point of view.
2. Derive a key question or problem from the review to motivate your work.

Discuss this topic with your supervisor in the timetabled supervision meetings. You will receive informal feedback on your proposal, which you should use to iterate upon your ideas. From there, carry out an extensive research and innovation project using industry-standard project management principles and techniques. You will receive regular informal feedback about your work through meetings with your supervisor. Iteratively improve the artefact and show it to your supervisor in a timetabled meeting. As the requirements for the artefact will vary by project, consult with your supervisor to verify whether the artefact is adequate for the desired purpose.

Project Proposal (20%)

The proposal is worth 20% of the overall marks for this module. It is assessed individually on a criterion basis, according to the rubric at the end of this document.

The proposal has two components: a presentation and a proposal form. Both are submitted to Learning Space and assessed together.

Part A: Proposal Presentation

Prepare a 10-minute presentation that addresses the following questions:

1. What is the context of your project?
2. How does it fit into your specific field?
3. What are the key results, from academic literature and/or from state-of-the-art, upon which your project will be built?
4. What are the key research questions that you will seek to answer in your project?
5. What will be the final format of your artefact?
6. Who is the audience for your artefact, and what need does it fulfil for them?
7. What are the key legal, social, ethical, and/or professional issues associated with your project?

You will receive immediate informal feedback from supervisors in the session, and formal written feedback within three weeks of the timetabled proposal session. Be prepared to defend your proposal in Q&A.

Part B: Proposal Form

Submit a completed Proposal Form to Learning Space at the time of your presentation. The form is a short structured document that records the key commitments made in your proposal and provides the basis for your supervisor's formal feedback. It covers the following:

- Research question and project title
- Proposed artefact format and intended audience
- Summary of methodology and key academic/practice references
- Ethics considerations and confirmation of whether a full ethics application is required
- Project plan: key milestones, potential blockers, and contingency
- **Process documentation method:** the approach you will use to document your development process throughout the module (e.g. blog, dev log, sketchbook, version control repository, design portfolio). This must be appropriate to your artefact type and approved by your supervisor.

The Proposal Form is available as a separate document on Learning Space. Your supervisor's written feedback on the proposal will confirm whether your proposed process documentation method is appropriate. This confirmation serves as the record of approval; no separate sign-off is required.

Artefact (80%)

Your artefact is worth 80% of the overall marks for this module. It is assessed as a single, integrated submission comprising two mandatory components: the artefact itself and an accompanying reflective video. Assessment is conducted primarily against the artefact; the reflective video contextualises the work and informs feedback, but does not carry a separate grade.

All artefacts are assessed against the shared criteria in the Artefact Marking Rubric below. You must evidence an iterative process and document your critical thinking throughout development. The assessor must be able to identify how your project has developed from its initial concept, through a series of prototypes or iterations, to the final deliverable. Your process documentation — the method confirmed at proposal stage — is the primary means by which this evidence is made visible, and should be included in or clearly linked from your artefact submission.

Part A: Artefact Submission

Upload a .zip file containing the final version of your artefact, any assets or dependencies, and your process documentation (or a clearly labelled link to it) to Learning Space.

Learning Space will only accept a single .zip file with a maximum size of 1 gigabyte. If your file is too large, you may be permitted to submit a link to materials hosted elsewhere — for example, a repository on the Games Academy Git server, your own GitHub, or a shared folder on the university's OneDrive. Discuss this with your supervisor and/or the module leader prior to submission.

If the nature of your artefact requires special handling, this will be discussed with your supervisor.

IMPORTANT: Your repository or link must be valid and accessible until your final grade is released and cannot be modified after the final deadline. Your grade may be invalidated or counted as a non-submission if files have been modified or are no longer accessible after the deadline.

Part B: Reflective Video

Upload a single video file, or an unlisted link to a hosted video, to Learning Space alongside your artefact. The reflective video allows you to explain and contextualise your work in your own voice, and provides the primary basis for your assessor's written feedback.

The video is a mandatory component of the submission. A submission without a reflective video will be treated as incomplete.

Your reflective video should address the following questions:

1. What is the context and high-level concept of your project?
2. How did you approach the development of the project?
3. What answers did you find to the key research questions you set out to explore?
4. Does your artefact fulfil the need you identified for your target audience? Why, or why not?
5. What are the wider implications and value of your work?
6. What potential is there for future work?

The standard video length is 10 minutes. Depending on your artefact type, additional content may be expected within or alongside the video — see the artefact-type requirements below.

The reflective video replaces the previously timetabled viva presentation. There is no live presentation or Q&A session for the artefact component. Formal written feedback will be returned within 15 working days of the submission deadline.

Artefact-type submission requirements

In addition to the standard components above, the following additional requirements apply depending on your artefact type. Where your artefact does not fit neatly into one of these categories, discuss expectations with your supervisor.

Software product (game, app, tool, or prototype)

- Include a README or equivalent document specifying system requirements and instructions for running the build.
- Include a walkthrough video or recorded gameplay footage (approximately 5 minutes) demonstrating the core features of the artefact. This may be incorporated into the reflective video or submitted as a separate file.
- Where a working build cannot be reliably distributed to assessors (e.g. hardware-dependent builds, live-service components, multiplayer-only experiences), a recorded demonstration is required and should be flagged to your supervisor in advance.

Written dissertation

- Submit as a single PDF or Word document, formatted to the conventions of your discipline.
- No additional video content beyond the standard 10-minute reflective video is required.
- Ensure that all references are complete and formatted consistently using an appropriate citation convention.

Portfolio of creative work

- Present the portfolio as a coherent, professionally formatted document or dedicated online portfolio, with accompanying process work where relevant.
- Include a walkthrough video (approximately 5 minutes) guiding the assessor through the portfolio and explaining key creative decisions. This may be incorporated into the reflective video or submitted separately.

Other artefact types

- Discuss with your supervisor what additional submission materials are appropriate. Confirm this at proposal stage so that expectations are clear before development begins.

Project Guidance**Ethical clearance**

All students must follow Falmouth University's Research Ethics Policy. In practice, this means you may need to complete the Research Ethics Approval Application Form and obtain ethical clearance before using your artefact to collect primary data, even where that data collection presents minimal risk.

If your project involves human participants (for example, playtesting a game system you have developed), or presents a significant ethical risk (for example, systems that process personal data), you will need to complete the full Research Ethics Approval Application Form, available on the Falmouth Integrity & Ethics page linked below. Discuss matters of an ethical nature with your supervisor and pay particular attention to how you address these issues in your research methodology. The ethics form should be submitted as part of the final artefact submission.

Read more about Falmouth University's Integrity and Ethics policy: falmouth.ac.uk/research/research-ethics-integrity

Project management

The major project can be a daunting prospect. Many students find it challenging because of its self-directed nature and the discipline required to sustain it. Do not worry — completing the project is intellectually liberating and a mark of your academic independence. It will provide you with something you can showcase in an interview and discuss with enthusiasm. Successful completion demands initiative, problem-solving, self-regulated learning, and planning.

A pitfall many students fall into is time management. Minimise procrastination and try to chip away at your work a little every day. Although your milestones will vary by project, the artefact should be approaching completion by week 10 of the module. Be sure to document, organise, and reflect on your process as you go — do not underestimate the value of this.

Use appropriate project management tools including critical path analysis, Gantt charts, and burn-down charts to track your progress. Do not underestimate the importance of validation and verification: ensure sufficient time is made for quality assurance practices that demonstrate your artefact was constructed through the sound application of pipelines and processes applicable to your specialism.

If you encounter issues with time management, consult your supervisor. Also take advantage of the support services offered by the Academic Skills Team (ASK): ask.fxplus.ac.uk

FAQ

How will I be assessed?

Your proposal presentation and proposal form will be marked against the Proposal Marking Rubric. Your artefact submission and reflective video will be marked against the Artefact Marking Rubric. Assessment of the artefact is conducted primarily against the submitted work; the reflective video informs the assessor's understanding and forms the basis for written feedback.

How will I receive my feedback?

Proposal feedback will be delivered in the session and formally returned within three weeks of the proposal presentation. Artefact feedback will be returned as written comments within 15 working days of the submission deadline. There is no live viva or Q&A for the artefact component.

What do I need to submit, and where?

For the proposal: upload your completed Proposal Form to Learning Space at the time of your presentation. For the artefact: upload your .zip file (containing your artefact, process documentation, and any additional materials as specified above) and your reflective video to Learning Space by the specified deadline, no later than 4pm on the day. We recommend submitting well in advance of the deadline.

How long should the proposal presentation be?

10 minutes, with up to 5 minutes for questions. Feedback will be delivered immediately after.

How long should the reflective video be?

The standard length is 10 minutes. Additional content (walkthrough footage, demonstration video) may be required depending on your artefact type — see the artefact-type requirements above.

Who can I contact for further guidance?

Your first point of contact should be your project supervisor. You can also contact the module leader at: william.huber@falmouth.ac.uk

Can I change my project concept partway through?

Yes — it is a natural part of any project that your concept and aims will shift as the project evolves and as you receive feedback. The project you propose initially is not set in stone; allowing it to evolve is a key part of agile project management. However, caution is advised before making radical changes, especially as the final deadline draws closer. Your supervisor can advise. Note that any significant change to your artefact type or process documentation method should be discussed with and confirmed by your supervisor.

Can I use asset packs or open-source software libraries?

Yes — this is a good way of managing the scope of a complex project. However, any work that is not your own must be properly credited. You will only receive credit for your own work, so you must ensure you are adding significant value to any third-party material you use.

Use of AI tools and AI-generated material

Artificial intelligence tools — including generative AI for text, image, audio, code, and other outputs — are increasingly part of professional and creative practice in the games and creative technology industries. This module does not prohibit their use. However, their use must be transparent, purposeful, and critically reflected upon. These requirements apply to all students on all programmes.

Transparency means disclosing how AI tools have been used in your project. This disclosure should appear in your process documentation and be addressed in your reflective video. You should be specific: which tools, for what purpose, and at what stage of the project.

Purposeful application means that your use of AI tools should be a considered methodological choice, not a substitute for your own intellectual or creative contribution. You are responsible for all work submitted under your name. Where AI tools have generated content that forms part of your artefact, you must be able to

demonstrate that you have exercised critical judgement over that content — selecting, evaluating, refining, and taking responsibility for it.

Critical reflection means engaging analytically with what AI use meant for your practice, your process, and the outcomes of your project. This is not a disclaimer but a genuine component of the intellectual work of the module. What did using AI enable? What did it foreclose? How did it shape your decisions?

The university's Academic Integrity Policy identifies using generative AI to produce a significant volume of content that is then submitted as your own work without acknowledgement as a form of academic misconduct. Undisclosed AI use — regardless of extent — is therefore a breach of this policy and of the principles of this module.

For students whose artefact uses AI as its primary medium or subject — for example, a trained model, a generative system, or an AI-assisted creative pipeline — the above principles remain in force, but the framing shifts. The question is not whether AI use is permissible, but how your authorial and intellectual contribution is established. In these cases, the artefact itself is evidence of your practice; the process documentation, proposal, and reflective video are where you make that contribution legible. Discuss the framing of your project's contribution with your supervisor at proposal stage.

Proposal Marking Rubric

CRITERION	WEIGHT	NEAR PASS	PASS	MERIT	DISTINCTION
Attainment (LEARNING OUTCOMES)	30%		Using well-judged presentation techniques, you have effectively pitched a sophisticated research and development proposal to your supervisor and other key stakeholders. A variety of sources, including both academic and grey literature, are cited using a relevant convention. There is a clear introduction, opportunity, aims and objectives, contextual review, methodology, pathway to impact, and risk analysis. You have critically evaluated the pertinent legal, social, ethical, professional, and sustainability issues in your proposed project. This includes consideration for: the implications of your chosen methods; the risks weighed against potential impact; mitigations where appropriate, and ethical approval where necessary. There is no evidence of academic misconduct.		
Delivery (COMMUNICATE)	7%	You present with some clarity.	You present with clarity.	You present with clarity and enthusiasm. Your delivery has few hesitation markers.	You present with confidence, clarity, enthusiasm, and persuasiveness. Your delivery is exquisite and without hesitation markers.
Flair (COMMUNICATE)	14%	Your presentation has working audiovisual materials.	Your presentation has clean audiovisual materials. They are also aesthetically coherent.	Your presentation has crisp audiovisual materials which support the comprehension of key points. They are also aesthetically pleasing.	Your presentation makes ingenious use of audiovisual materials which emphatically support a clear understanding of the proposal as a whole. They are also leveraging aesthetic techniques in a creative way to effectively engage the audience.
Pacing (COMMUNICATE)	14%	You articulate the direction of your proposal in the available time.	You clearly articulate your proposal in full within the available time, following a reasonable	You clearly articulate your proposal in full within the available time, following a structure which	You clearly articulate your proposal parsimoniously within the available time, following a structure which

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Value (INDUSTRY)	14%	You outline the wider context of your proposal.	structure which attends to each aspect. You locate your proposal in its wider context and the opportunity you're seeking to address, showing your motivation.	suitably supports each aspect. You situate your proposal in the context of your field and the opportunity you are seeking to address, indicating its value by highlighting how it might build upon contemporary art.	effectively reinforces its most important aspects. You clearly situate your proposal within the recent discourse of your field and the opportunity you are seeking to address, persuasively illustrating its value by justifying its timeliness, how it might build upon the state-of-the-art, and how it may benefit stakeholders. You make a pithy and yet compelling case for originality, significance, or reach at the regional, national, or international level.
Risk (INDUSTRY)	7%	You identify and evaluate some legal, social, ethical, professional, and sustainability issues. You demonstrate some critical thinking.	You identify and evaluate many of the pertinent legal, social, ethical, professional, and sustainability issues associated with your proposal. You are critical in your evaluation, yielding insights.	You identify and evaluate all of the pertinent and important legal, social, ethical, professional, and sustainability issues associated with your proposal. You are critical in your evaluation, yielding detailed and actionable insights.	You identify and evaluate all of the pertinent and important legal, social, ethical, professional, and sustainability issues associated with your proposal. You are critical in your evaluation, yielding ground-breaking, well substantiated, and actionable insights. You demonstrate a systematic approach to due diligence alongside wisdom which would be valuable to share to inform practices and policies in other domains.
Approach (INDUSTRY)	14%	Your proposed approach is sufficient.	Your proposed approach is ethically-informed and is compliant with ethical policy. You have selected methods that ought to address the opportunity you have identified without controversy.	Your proposed approach is well considered ethically, weighing issues against benefits, and is explicitly aligned to ethical policy. You have selected and justified methods that ought to soundly address the opportunity you have identified without concern. The link between your risk	Your proposed approach is grounded in ethics, assessing the likely risks in light of its potential value, and is explicitly aligned to ethical policy as well as to wider national or international frameworks. You have selected and convincingly justified methods that ought to soundly address the opportunity you

CRITERION	WEIGHT	NEAR PASS	PASS	MERIT	DISTINCTION
				assessment and planning is clear.	have identified. The connections between your risk assessment and the design of your work packages is clear. The research and/or development methods illustrated are sophisticated and likely to inform the state-of-the-art.

Artefact Marking Rubric

CRITERION	WEIGHT	NEAR PASS	PASS	MERIT	DISTINCTION
Research: does the project reflect awareness of the current state of the art in practice or scholarship?	20%	The project shows limited engagement with relevant work in the field. Key references, precedents, or contemporary practice are missing or superficially acknowledged.	The project demonstrates awareness of relevant work in the field. Key references and precedents are acknowledged and inform the work in identifiable ways.	The project demonstrates well-developed awareness of the field, engaging critically with a range of relevant sources, precedents, or contemporary practice. The work is clearly situated within current discourse.	The project demonstrates comprehensive and critical engagement with the state of the art. The work responds to, challenges, or advances current discourse in the field in ways that are substantive and well-evidenced.
Research: does the project demonstrate understanding of the methods, conventions, and standards of craft relevant to the discipline — including the execution, finish, and presentation expected of work at this level?	25%	The project shows limited understanding of relevant disciplinary methods or conventions. Execution and finish fall short of the standard expected at Masters level in identifiable ways.	The project demonstrates understanding of relevant methods and conventions. The artefact is executed to a competent standard and presented in a manner appropriate to the discipline.	The project demonstrates secure command of relevant methods and conventions. The artefact is executed with care and consistency, and its finish reflects a clear understanding of disciplinary standards. The work would be recognisable as competent to a professional or specialist audience.	The project demonstrates sophisticated command of relevant methods and conventions. The artefact is executed to a high standard of craft and finish, commensurate with publishable or professionally releasable work. The choices made in its realisation are well-judged and clearly defensible.
Innovate: does the delivery of this project show originality in problem-solving and the innovative application of tools, techniques, and methods — and is that innovation realised to a standard that makes it credible and communicable?	25%	The project shows limited evidence of original problem-solving. The application of tools, techniques, or methods is largely conventional, and/or the realisation does not adequately	The project demonstrates identifiable originality in its approach to problem-solving or in its application of tools, techniques, or methods. The realisation is sufficient to make	The project demonstrates well-developed originality in problem-solving and a purposeful application of tools, techniques, or methods. The realisation is of sufficient quality that the innovative	The project demonstrates a high degree of originality in problem-solving and a sophisticated, well-justified application of tools, techniques, or methods. The innovation is realised to a standard that makes

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		support the innovative intent.	the innovation legible.	contribution is clearly communicated and credible.	it compelling and fully communicable — the work itself is the argument.
Innovate: does this project demonstrate potential for creative and/or intellectual leadership in the relevant field?	10%	The project has limited implications beyond its immediate scope. Little consideration is given to its wider significance or potential.	The project has identifiable implications for the field. Some consideration is given to its wider significance or potential for further development.	The project makes a credible contribution to the field and demonstrates awareness of its wider significance. The potential for further development or impact is articulated with some specificity.	The project makes a distinctive contribution to the field and demonstrates clear potential for creative or intellectual leadership. The student can articulate a convincing case for the work's significance, originality, or reach, and for the directions in which it could be taken forward.
Reflect: is this project consistent with the student's professional aspirations and future directions?	10%	The connection between the project and the student's professional aspirations is unclear or asserted without evidence.	The project is relevant to the student's professional aspirations and future directions. The connection is stated and broadly plausible.	The project is well-aligned with the student's professional aspirations. The student can articulate how the project develops relevant skills, knowledge, or positioning, and how it supports their future directions with some specificity.	The project is an excellent, well-evidenced expression of the student's professional aspirations and future directions. The student demonstrates a sophisticated understanding of how the work positions them within the field, and articulates a compelling and credible trajectory for further development.
Reflect: is there evidence of sustained critical self-reflection about the development of the project?	10%	Reflection on the project's development is limited or largely descriptive. There is little evidence of critical self-assessment or of reflection informing decisions.	There is evidence of self-reflection about the project's development. The student can identify key decisions and outcomes, and offers some assessment of what worked and what did not.	There is good evidence of sustained and critical self-reflection throughout the project's development. The student analyses key decisions with specificity, draws meaningful conclusions, and demonstrates that reflection has actively shaped the work.	There is excellent, insightful, and well-expressed critical reflection on the project's development. The student demonstrates a sophisticated capacity for self-assessment, situating their decisions and outcomes within the broader context of their practice and the field. Reflection is evidently generative — it has shaped the work in demonstrable ways.